was not primarily responsible for these fortunate results. In Kapur's view, then, the region's future may not resemble the past. India and Pakistan may not be able to defuse their next confrontation before reaching the point of major conventional or nuclear conflict. Thus disaster remains a real possibility in a nuclear South Asia.

Is Ganguly's view correct? Or does Kapur's approach prevail? The answer to this question depends on the importance that one assigns to the outcomes of South Asian militarized disputes versus the processes by which those disputes erupted, escalated, and were resolved. Does one care more about what actually happened in past Indo-Pakistani confrontations or what could have happened? Those who take an outcome-based approach will tend to be optimistic about nuclear weapons' regional effects. For in the end, confrontations and crises in a nuclear South Asia have always been resolved without large-scale escalation. Those who take a process-based approach will tend to be pessimistic about nuclear weapons' regional effects. For despite generally benign results in the past, repeatedly navigating through the outbreak, escalation, and resolution of Indo-Pakistani crises is an uncertain and risky endeavor.

Whether an outcome- or a process-based approach is superior, then, is a matter of judgment. Deductive reasoning cannot determine whether benign past outcomes are more important than future risky processes or vice versa. This does not mean, of course, that serious differences between the two approaches do not remain. In the end, Ganguly's focus on outcome leads to the conclusion that nuclear weapons have made South Asia substantially safer, while Kapur's focus on process leads to the conclusion that the region is significantly more dangerous. And these differences affect not only our analysis of past cases of nuclear proliferation but also our view of potential proliferation in the future. If the outcomes of future crises between nuclear powers are likely to resemble those of the past, then the possibility of further proliferation elsewhere around the globe is not particularly worrisome. Indeed, it may even be desirable. But if the processes of crisis outbreak, escalation, and resolution in a nuclear environment are dangerous and uncertain, the results of future disputes may not resemble those of the past. If this is the